r/Fencing • 6d ago
u/lugh_the_bard

Is this scene bs?

r/theprincessbride • 7 days ago
Bonetti's defense



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However both the actors have exceptional sword handling generally (especially with both hands!) and you'd be hard pressed to find two fencers able to perform the stage choreography that well.

Also, as mentioned, all the fencing master referenced are real fencing masters.

325 Reply ···

htxatty • 6d ago

The Cliffs of Insanity do exist. It is the R.O.U.S. that do not exist. 🐀🐀🐀

73 Reply ···

BecomeAsGod • 6d ago

wrong r.o.u.s can be found in New York

37 Reply ···

1n1t4c01n5 • 5d ago

That's exactly what Big Capybara wants you to believe

9 Reply ···

rpgmaps0 • 6d ago

Rodents Of Unusual Size? I don't think they exist.

15 Reply ···

spookmann • 6d ago

Épée

Rhode Islands of Unusual Size?

Aren't they North of NY?

10 Reply ···

Towerbells • 5d ago

I used to work comercial trash collection . We have ine place that was a covered alley with restaurants on both sides . ROUS absolutely do exist

3 Reply ···

MoreColdOnesPlz • 2d ago

Google 'nutria'

1 Reply ···

rewt127 • 6d ago

They arent using the techniques they are mentioning, but yes they are real.

73 Reply ...

GallantArmor • 3d ago

The point of the exchange is that Inigo recognizes the skill of The Man in Black by expressing that he knows the move as well as the counter. The Man in Black responds, saying that it is good that Inigo didn't use that counter, as he knows the counter-counter. Inigo responds, saying that it would have been fine, as he knows the counter-counter-counter.

It wouldn't have made sense if Inigo actually used the counter. They are having a theoretical sparring match while actually sparring, using different techniques than the ones they are discussing.

7 Reply ...

Demphure • 6d ago

Sabre

Not really, just outdated. It does indeed reference old masters, some of whom were responsible for bringing attention to techniques still used today, albeit very differently.

What's cooler is based off the specialties of those mentioned, the conversation does make sense. I think there's an article or video out there explaining it

93 Reply ...

CommunicationKey3018 • 6d ago

I don't think the conversation makes sense. "Bonetti's defense" on rocky terrain is not a thing. Unless they're referring to the way he died in a duel.

Thibault does not "cancel out" Capoferro. The only way I can make that make sense is by assuming they are referring more generally about the rivalry between Italian tradition and Destreza. But even then, Thibault is not really a part of the Destreza tradition, it's a hybrid of Destreza and French fencing.

46 Reply ...

Cold_Activity1092 • 6d ago

I did not understand any of your arguments in this post, and I love that so much.

24 Reply ...

rewt127 • 6d ago

Honestly in a way it kind of does. If they take the extreme forward position of Capo Ferro. Retreating into the tall comfortable positions favored by Thibault are a solid counter. Since you can just sit there jerkin it until they get tired.

But they also arent doing these techniques they are mentioning.

32 Reply ...

CommunicationKey3018 • 6d ago

rewt127 • 6d ago

Yeah, its an even more extreme version of what Capo Ferro says to do.

Especially as the removed Capo Ferro guard is even more comfortable than Thibault.

7 Reply ···

CommunicationKey3018 • 6d ago • Edited 6d ago

What I like about the Thibault grip is it's similarity to the thumb grip in German longsword. So parrying inside or outside line only requires horizontal translation of the hand instead of translation and rotation. And the cuts come from very hard to predict angles. Like mini one-handed Zwerchaus. ~~That is maybe TMI for this particular sub though.~~

8 Reply ···

rewt127 • 6d ago

Yeah. Probably too much for here lol.

But personally I prefer the other Destreza position which rotated 90°. As I primarily use a late Italian low guard, so if pressured, I just raise straight up, and can work the opponents guard from there.

But if starting from one of those positions Thibault is probably superior.

Also. Even if its an MOF sub. This image and the discussion at hand is historical fencing. So at least in this thread it is topical.

6 Reply ···

CommunicationKey3018 • 6d ago

I can see that. If you are already a fan of the Terza guard, then the Destreza middle guard will immediately feel familiar.

5 Reply ···

rewt127 • 6d ago

Oh im not in Terza. Im even lower. You seem familiar with Historical fencing so the name drop will probably land. I train Robert Child's fencing system. Which the basic guard is super late Italian. Basically as the rapier was on the way out.

EDIT: It functions basically as a rapier Alber guard.

6 Reply ···

CommunicationKey3018 • 6d ago • Edited 6d ago

Gotcha. I've seen Rob Childs in action. Right, that'd be called Alber guard in KDF. Great for false edge deflection parries. Very cool to meet you!

Solved. Ty

2 Reply ···

boredidiot • 5d ago

This is Guy Windsor's article, which references the book and the differences as well. https://medium.com/@guywindsor/the-princess-bride-how-does-thibault-cancel-out-capoferro-4110b790facd

3 Reply ···

FifteenEchoes • 6d ago

Sabre

I don't know about "outdated", since Olympic fencing is a very different beast than dueling with real swords. The blade is so much lighter than even a smallsword.

13 Reply ···

Demphure • 6d ago

Sabre

It came from somewhere. Yes it's extremely different, but the concepts weren't born as their own thing, they evolved from actual fencing. Target area, priority, and many basic techniques all came from various historical fencing styles

2 Reply ···

FifteenEchoes • 6d ago

Sabre

Yes, but they're hardly doing Olympic fencing in the movie. Saying that the old masters are "outdated" because their systems don't really apply to Olympic fencing is like saying that advice on oil painting is "outdated" because it doesn't apply to photography.

8 Reply ···

HarrisonJackal • 6d ago

What video? 👀

5 Reply ···

Demphure • 6d ago

Sabre

Found it. There are probably others, this is just the one I know about

https://youtu.be/fbyjUyFWDnY?is=Hb5rG6LnaT3OpO2w

5 Reply ···

oreo-cat- • 6d ago • Edited 6d ago

All the fencing masters mentioned existed, and Capo Ferro, Agrippa and Thibault left surviving manuals. There's scans of them up on Wiktenauer I believe if you're interested. That said, you don't usually name drop random

MurkyCress521 • 6d ago • Edited 6d ago

Maybe not foil because it is so fast but in rapier, you see someone fencing in the style of Thibault while you are in a Italian posture like Capo Ferro. You can communicate that you know what they are up to by say placing your forte wide to the inside or outside and seeing if they follow it to gain blade contact. If they are good they will see the bait for what it ism No words are exchanged but two experienced rapier fencers, especially in a more playful low stakes setting, can have a conversation with the swords without words. To make that work in a movie, you need to add the words

The sort of, you know that I know that you know, mind games.

22 Reply ···

weedywet • 6d ago

Foil Top 1% Poster

But what if I know something you don't know?

7 Reply ···

oreo-cat- • 6d ago

Yes. But you don't shout about how you're fencing like Capo Ferro at them. Or at least I don't and I've been in quite a few rapier bouts over the years.

10 Reply ···

Sakowuf_Solutions • 6d ago

...you don't?

14 Reply ···

oreo-cat- • 6d ago

I mean you do you boo. Live your best fencing master shouting life.

8 Reply ···

Sakowuf_Solutions • 6d ago

FIORE!

9 Reply ···

oreo-cat- • 6d ago

If you're reading Fiore and fencing rapier you've messed up somewhere. I guess you can always try to break their elbows. Can I interest you in FABRIS? Or ALFIERI?

4 Reply ···

Sakowuf_Solutions • 5d ago

You fence rapier.

😂

4 Reply ...

PuppyLover2208 • 5d ago

I'm more of a Mike Hundt type of guy. :)

3 Reply ...

oreo-cat- • 5d ago

Still my favorite 1 vs many illustration

1 Reply ...

whiskey_epsilon • 5d ago

The names are real, the moves onscreen do not depict the techniques associated with the names (no, Agrippa does not utilise somersaults). Also, one doesn't just attack with "capo ferro", like, it's not a Hadouken you can just throw out or something.

In the book, the sequence is different:

> the man in black immediately began the Agrippa defence, which Inigo felt was sound, considering the rocky terrain, for the Agrippa kept the feet stationary at first... Naturally, he countered with Capo Ferro, which surprised the man in black, but he defended well, quickly shifting out of Agrippa and taking the attack himself, using the principles of Thibault... He let the man in black advance... letting his Bonetti defence keep him safe from harm.

6 Reply ...

Imperium_Dragon • 6d ago

Épée

Thibault does not, in fact, cancel Capo Ferro. (Reciting Thibault's fencing manual will put your enemies to sleep though).

19 Reply ...

siimbelmyne • 6d ago

Épée

It was choreographed by a real fencer (Bob Anderson), so it was at least made with an understanding of how fencing works even if some of it is a little unrealistic because it's stage combat/fantasy

38 Reply ...

thoout • 5d ago

Épée Coach

9 Reply ···

dwneev775 • 4d ago

Foil

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bob_Anderson_(fencer) for those unfamiliar with him.

3 Reply ···

TylerKeroga • 3d ago

Épée

Holy shit, getting FIVE gold/silver medals across foil, saber, & épée in an international tournament is INSANE skill! Most sport fencers have little to no skill with more than one of the three aforementioned (myself included), so him being so highly skilled in *all three* is legendary. No wonder he was the prime fencing choreographer in Hollywood

1 Reply ···

dwneev775 • 3d ago

Foil

Well, although being a successful competitive fencer can certainly help inform oneself, being a fight choreographer is a separate discipline and skill-set. Think of it this way: as a competitive fencer you want to make things such that a skilled opponent in front of you is not able to fully follow what is happening until after you have scored; as a fight choreographer you want to create a scene that people with no knowledge of swordplay sitting in the back row can follow.

1 Reply ···

LitespeedClassic • 5d ago

I highly recommend listening to the audio book of *As You Wish*. It's written and mostly read by Cary Elwes (with some cameos from the rest of the still living cast).

It's an incredible memoirs about the making of the film. In the script for the film the direction for this fight was something like: *Put the greatest sword duel in Hollywood history here.*

Elwes and Patinkin spent months training with personal fencing coaches leading up to the filming. They watched and critiqued every sword dual that had ever appeared in film. During filming, if they weren't in a scene, they were practicing with their trainers. IIRC they didn't have them practice together too much, because they wanted each to develop their own distinctive fencing style and to see the clash of the styles when they finally came together (though I may be inventing that in my head).

5 Reply ···

Linkthealmighty • 6d ago

If you're interested in the topic, I highly recommend As You Wish by Carrey Elwis. He goes through the whole training process for the scene, plus a ton of other fun facts from the movie.

10 Reply ···

2 Reply ···

LeadershipElectronic • 4d ago

Bunch of shrieking eels in the comments....

3 Reply ···

hdorsettcase • 6d ago

The words are fencing masters. There are indeed moves that counter moves in fencing. Taken literally its BS. Taken as two experts using techniques to counter techniques it makes sense.

2 Reply ···

Unlikely-Visual-4990 • 3d ago

Filmed in Ireland

2 Reply ···

Unlikely-Visual-4990 • 3d ago

Some of it was filmed outside Sheffield in the Peak District. My partner's dad was an extra in it

1 Reply ···

SmolBrain42 • 6d ago

Foil

It's bad fencing

-9 Reply ···

rewt127 • 6d ago • Edited 6d ago

Its... fine.

Its obviously exaggerated, but when fighting on uneven ground, going into those more cutting focused guards can allow you to focus more on your footing while still being able to cover yourself.

Point on is great when you are in a controlled position. But bringing your tip up as you maneuver is perfectly acceptable.

EDIT: Also being able to threaten the cut while moving around is a great way to make your opponent give you space while you reset. Obviously it wouldnt apply to epee or Foil, but the context here is of a sharp sword and no throat protection. So a cut in the right spot is pretty immediately fatal and would force your opponent to respect the edge.

4 Reply ···

weedywet • 6d ago

8 Reply ...



SmolBrain42 • 6d ago

Foil

Fairs

2 Reply ...

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